

Romans

Peace with God and Life in Grace

Ch. 5

<https://tinyurl.com/RomeGospel>

The Grace of God Revealed

How *the* perfectly just LORD *has* forgiven sin...!

*“Blessed is he whose transgression is **forgiven**,
whose sin is **covered**,
Blessed is the man to whom
the **LORD** does **not impute iniquity**,
And in whose spirit there is **no deceit**.”*

• ***Psalm 32:1-2; Romans 4:7-8***

*“...that **He might be just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus**.”* Romans 3:26

FIRST - Read Romans 3:21-26

THE QUESTION:

- How can a perfectly **just** God forgive sins?
- How can **sinful** man find favor with a **righteous** God?

THE ANALOGY:

- God (the Son) presides as the Judge of mankind (pagan, moral, and spiritual men). John 5:22
- The Son steps down from the Judgment seat and assumes the seat of the plaintiff (mankind). Isaiah 53:11
- The Son himself assumes the just penalty of sin for all of sinful mankind.
- The Father is satisfied with the just payment for sin.
- The Father demonstrates mercy by extending the righteousness of one man to cover many. 2 Cor. 5:21

God demonstrates His perfect justice at the same time that he demonstrates His perfect mercy... in the act of delivering justice, he also justifies.

Eph. 2:8 “For by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, not of works, lest anyone should boast.

Hallelujah! What a Savior!

God justifies sinners by faith, not by works, and Abraham is the pattern for all who believe.

GOD's Intrinsic Motivation

Why did God do this? Because of His own character.

3:25 "...**to demonstrate His righteousness**, because in His forbearance God had passed over the sins that were previously committed, **to demonstrate** at the present time **His righteousness**, that He might be the just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus."

GOD's character traits:

- Sovereign (accountable only to Himself)
- Omniscient (knows all; supremely insightful)
- Omnipotent (all powerful; creative designer)
- Omnipresent (non-local; unbounded by time and space)
- Immutable (unchanging; uncompromising character)
- Love (highest of personality)
- Truth (personification of reality)
- Just (absolute righteousness; His own standard; links with Sovereign)
- Merciful (Perfectly in balance with His Just-ness)
- Holy (Spiritually Pure; Uncompromising Virtue)

What about the Here and Now?

Now, the blessings of God flow to those Justified by Faith.

*“Therefore, having been justified by faith, **we have peace with God** through our Lord Jesus Christ...” Romans 5:1*

What kind of peace?

- World Peace...?
- Tranquility of the Soul...?
 - *“Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you; not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.” John 14:27*
- **Peace with God...?**
 - *“...and the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding...” Philippians 4:7*
 - “peace with”
 - Implies relationship; understanding; access to
 - Not in the sense of “making peace”, but rather in the sense of “enjoying peace”.
 - Claiming the gift of peace with God by faith.
 - Access to approach the throne through whom?

What about the Here and Now?

Now, the blessings of God flow to those Justified by Faith.

*“...through whom also **we have access by faith into this grace** in which we stand, and rejoice in hope of the glory of God.” v. 5:2*

into this grace...

- We can rejoice! We could not have earned it, and yet it is freely given.

What if we try to earn it...?

- “And **if by grace**, then **it is** no longer of works; otherwise grace is no longer grace. But **if it is of works**, it is no longer grace; otherwise work is no longer work.” Romans 11:6
 - **Attempting to earn it represents a form of rejection of the intent of the Giver!**

How have you received salvation? *Ephesians 2:8-9*

Why? *Ephesians 2:7*

What do we do in response? *Colossians 2:6, Romans 1:5*

How then shall we live? *Galatians 2:17-21; 3:11*

Whom is the key? *2 Cor. 5:17, 21*

What about the Here and Now?

Now, the blessings of God flow to those Justified by Faith.

*“And not only that, but we also glory in tribulations, knowing that tribulation produces **perseverance**; and perseverance, **character**; and character, **hope**. Now hope does not disappoint, because the **love of God** has been poured out in our hearts by the **Holy Spirit** who was **given to us**.” Romans 5:3-5*

We enter into a process of maturing...

- “*we also glory*”; something to be excited about.
- Only the Christian God has plunged himself into the suffering that we all face in life. That we share this experience with God Himself is amazing. By sharing in His experience we also share in His triumph! (a corollary; Death-Burial-Resurrection → Baptism)
- “...*though He was a Son, yet He learned obedience by the things which He suffered.*” **Hebrews 5:8**
- The “end product” of this maturing process is hope. You will know it by perception.
- Can this gift of Grace be received in vain? **2 Corinthians 6:1-11**
 - How to measure maturity? By the presence of hope.

What about the Here and Now?

Why do Christians suffer trials and tribulations?

1. To Glorify God (Daniel 3:16-18; 24-25 – the Lion's Den)
2. Discipline for Sin (Hebrews 12:5-11; James 4:17; 1 John 1:9)
3. To Keep us from Sinning (1 Peter 4:12)
4. To Keep us from Pride (2 Cor. 12:7-10)
5. To Build Faith (1 Peter 1:6-7)
6. To Cause Growth (Romans 5:3-5)
7. To Teach Obedience and Discipline (Acts 9:15-16)
8. To Equip us to Comfort Others (2 Cor. 1:3-4)
9. To Prove the Reality of Christ in Us (2 Cor. 4:7-11)
10. For Testimony to the Angels (Job 1:8; Ephesian 3:8-11)

Thus... James 1:2-4

“My brethren, count it all joy when you fall into various trials, knowing that the testing of your faith produces patience. But let patience have its perfect work, that you may be perfect and complete, lacking nothing.”

What about the Here and Now?

How far have we come in our relationship to God?

*“For if when we were **enemies** we were reconciled to God through the death of His Son, **much more**, having been reconciled, we shall be saved by His life.” Romans 5:10*

“Enemies”

- *“Helpless”, “Ungodly”, “Sinners”, “Enemies” (Romans 5:6-11)*
- *Romans 8:7; James 4:4*

“Children”

- *If God loved you that much, while in that condition, how much more so now that you are His children?*
- *John 1:12*

Can the context of this new relationship be misconstrued? How?

- *By forgetting the continuous work of our Intercessor (Heb 7:25)*
- *By living in fear instead of awe (Philippians 2:12-13)*
- *By having the wrong motivation (1 Corinthians 3:11-15)*

What about the Here and Now?

Qualifying further what Christ has done for us...

- **Redemption** (pertains to sin; we are rescued from our fate)
 - *Rom 3:24; 1 Cor 1:30; Gal 3:13; Eph 1:7*
- **Propitiation** (pertains to God's judicial satisfaction)
 - *Rom 3:25; 1 John 2:2; 1 John 4:10*
- **Reconciliation** (this is **our** blessing; where we now stand)
 - *Rom 5:10-11; 2 Cor 5:18-20; Col 1:22 (atonement)*

Context, Context, Context... what is Paul's purpose?

- Paul is proceeding to the crescendo of Romans 8, the significant theological purpose of encouraging Christians and establishing **Joy** and **Hope** for those now living within the **Kingdom of God**.
- *Contextually, how might Romans 5 thru 8 be misinterpreted?*

*Context, Context, Context... what is the **Kingdom of God**?*

- Domain is both Heaven and Earth (Matt 6:10; Matt 28:18-20; John 15:6-10)
- The Kingdom has a King; Citizens; Rules (Matt 5:20; Matt 7:21-23; not the Law of Moses – Acts 15:28-29; Hebrews 8:7-13; Rev 3)
- What is the Kingdom of God like? (Matt 13:24-43; 47-50; 22:2-14)

Kingdom of God and Kingdom of Heaven are terms used synonymously (compare Matt 13 and Mark 4).

The rules of the Kingdom of God are obedience to Jesus' commands.
Romans 1:5 – “the obedience of faith”

What about the Here and Now?

What next? Sanctification

“Justification”

- **Declares** within God’s Holy Court that a sinner has been **imputed** righteousness. But has the sinner’s heart changed?

“Sanctification” Romans 5:12 thru Romans 8

- God has a plan within the context of Salvation whereby He not only **declares** a sinner righteous, but He is also going to **make** a sinner righteous.
- A way that a sinner may grow in grace and thus become “set apart” for God.

“Begins in 5:12 thru 5:21”

- Contrasts our descent thru Adam with our present union with Christ.
- Imputation occurs through this union with Christ. (ascribe/account)
- Adam; who is figure of Him who is to come.
 - 1 Cor. 15:45-49; Eph 5:25-32; 1 Tim 2:13-14